



b. 1977

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

Virva
Svala

SKILLS

HTML / CSS
JAVASCRIPT
REACT
NODE JS
TYPESCRIPT
SQL
PYTHON
JAVA
ADOBE CREATIVE CLOUD

EDUCATION

2025
M.Sc.
UNIVERSITY OF HELSINKI
COMPUTER SCIENCE

2012
Web Production
AV COMMUNICATION
OTAVA INSTITUTE

2009
MA,
Taik
ART EDUCATION

2003
MEd
UNIVERSITY OF OULU
TEACHER EDUCATION

CONTACT

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github.com/vsvala
virvasvala.com

ABOUT ME

Hi,
I am a software developer and Master of Science in Computer Science from the University of Helsinki (2025), with a background as an art teacher. I have over 6 years of hands-on experience as a software developer at Foreca, where I was responsible for Full Stack development and maintenance of consumer weather services, a B2B developer portal, and dynamic weather applications. I also served as a technical expert in service implementation and co-ordinating requirements between internal teams and customers. I joined Foreca right after completing my Bachelor's degree and finished my Master's studies alongside full-time work.

My core expertise lies in modern web development — particularly Node.js, React, TypeScript, JavaScript, and Next.js. My experience with weather applications includes fetching dynamic data from APIs and utilizing map libraries (Leaflet, MapLibre). Git version control and working in terminal environments are fluent tools for me. I am also familiar with agile methods Kanban and Scrum. In my work, I have actively adopted AI-assisted development tools such as GitHub Copilot and Claude Code.

In addition to my technical skills, I have an exceptionally strong visual eye: my background as an art teacher and the graphic work I did at Foreca — such as UI design, data visualization, and weather animations — translates into a hands-on approach to front-end development.

I am a social, positive, and creative team player, often described as an approachable colleague. I work smoothly in multidisciplinary teams with both technical and business professionals. My natural drive to keep learning constantly pushes me forward: I am currently deepening my knowledge in generative AI, RAG-based applications, and DevOps and cloud services.

WORK EXPERIENCE

IT sector:
SOFTWARE DEVELOPER 2020-2026
Foreca

COURSE ASSISTANT Summer 2019, Autumn 2019
Department of Computer Science, University of Helsinki

Education sector:
ART TEACHER 2011-2017
Munkkiniemi School

TEACHING AND INSTRUCTIONAL ROLES 2003-2017
I worked in diverse teaching roles as an art and physical education subject teacher and class teacher at various grade levels in primary school, upper secondary school, high school and vocational school. Also as headmaster and instructor at summer camps.

LANGUAGE SKILLS AND EXCHANGE STUDIES

FINNISH	██████████	NATIVE
ENGLISH	████████	FLUENT
SWEDISH	██████	GOOD
FRENCH	████	BASIC

Cyprus Finnish School, Teaching practice	Autumn 2001
Malmö University, School of education	Spring 2000
Haagse Hogeschool, The Hague, Netherlands	Autumn 1999

CIVIC AND VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

Academic Wine Society, equality and environmental officer	2018
KOL Board, student member	2004
AIESEC, trainee mentor	1998-1999
Tutor for new students	1998
Upper secondary school student council, secretary and treasurer	1993-1995

HOBBIES AND STRENGTHS

I paint with oils and keep active through dancing, yoga, and aerobics. My strengths include creativity, positivity, and strong organisational skills — paired with a natural curiosity and a drive to keep learning.